MIL-T-8878D
18 APRIL 1994
SUPERSEDING
MIL-T-8878C
08 October 1985

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

TURNBUCKLES, POSITIVE SAFETYING

This specification is approved for use within the Department of the Air Force and is available for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers positive safetying turnbuckle component parts.

2 APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Government documents.

2.1.1 Specifications, standards, and handbooks. The following specifications, standards, and handbooks form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of these documents are those listed in the issue of the Department of Defense Index of Specifications and Standards (DODISS) and supplement thereto, cited in the solicitation (see 6.2).

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

QQ-P-35	-	Passivation Treatments for Corrosion Resistant Steel
QQ-A-225/6	-	Aluminum Alloy 2024 Bar, Rod, and Wire; Rolled, Drawn or Cold Finished
QQ-P-416	-	Plating, Cadmium (Electrodeposited)
WW-T-700/3	-	Tube, Aluminum Alloy, Drawn, Seamless, 2024

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: the Resources and Logistics Services Division, SA-ALC/TILDD, Bldg 171, Post C-12, 485 Quentin Roosevelt Rd., Kelly AFB, TX 78241-6425 by using the Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

AMSC N/A FSC 5340

DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A Approved for public release, distribution in unlimited.

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QQ-S-763 - Steel Bars, Wire, Shapes and Forgings, Corrosion Resisting

MILITARY

MIL-P-116 - Preservation, Methods of
MIL-S-6050 - Steel, Chrome-Nickel-Molybdenum (8630) Bars and Reforging Stock (Aircraft Quality)
MIL-H-6088 - Heat Treatment of Aluminum Alloys
MIL-T-6736 - Tubing, Chrome-Molybdenum (4130 or 8630) Steel, Seamless and Welded
MIL-S-6758 - Steel, Chrome-Molybdenum (4130) Bars and Reforging Stock (Aircraft Quality)
MIL-H-6875 - Heat Treatment of Steel, Process for
MIL-T-6945 - Tubing, Brass, Seamless
MIL-S-7742 - Screw Threads, Standard, Optimum Selected Series. General Specification for
MIL-A-8625 - Anodic Coating, for Aluminum and Aluminum Alloys
MIL-G-9954 - Glass Beads: for Cleaning and Peening
MIL-C-16173 - Corrosion Preventive Compound, Solvent Cutback, Cold-Application

STANDARDS

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage (Part 1 of 4 parts)
MIL-STD-130 - Identification Marking of U.S. Military Property
MIL-STD-852 - Glass Bead Peening Procedures
MIL-STD-2073-1 - DOD Material Procedures for Development and Application of Packaging Requirements (Part 1 of 2 parts)
MS21252 - Clevis Rod End, Turnbuckle, Clip Locking
MS21253 - Clevis End, Turnbuckle, Clip Locking (for Bearing)
MS21254 - Connector, Rod End, Turnbuckle, Clip Locking
MS21255 - Connector, Rod End, Turnbuckle, Clip Locking
MS21256 - Clip, Locking, Turnbuckle
MS33736 - Turnbuckle Assemblies, Clip Locking of

(Unless otherwise indicted, copies of the federal and military specifications, standards and handbooks are available from the Defense Printing Service, Detachment Office, 700 Robbins Ave, Bldg 4D, Philadelphia, PA 19111-5094.)

2.2 Non-Government publications. The following document(s) form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of the documents which are DoD adopted are those listed in the issue of the DODISS cited in the solicitation. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of documents not listed in the DODISS are the issues of the documents cited in the solicitation (see 6.2).

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AMERICAN SOCIETY FOR TESTING MATERIALS (ASTM)

ASTM E8 - Materials, Metallic, Tension Testing Of
ASTM B21 - Standard Specification for Naval Brass Rod, Bar and Shapes E2 (DoD adopted)
ASTM A580 - Standard Specification for Stainless and Heat-Resisting Steel Wire (Not Current Document)
ASTM A630 - Standard Test Methods for Determination of Tin Coating Weights for Hot-Dip and Electrolytic Tin Plate

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103.)

SOCIETY OF AUTOMOTIVE ENGINEERS, INC.

AMS 6530 - Steel Tubing, Seamless 0.50Ni-0.55Cr-0.20Mo (0.28-0.33C) (SAE 8630) (Not Current Document)

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Society of Automotive Engineers, Inc., 400 Commonwealth Drive, Warrendale, PA 15096.)

(Non-Government standards and other publications are normally available from the organizations that prepare or distribute the documents. These documents also may be available in or through libraries or other informational services.)

2.3 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this document and the references cited herein (except for related associated detail specifications, specification sheets or MS standards), the text of this document takes precedence. Nothing in this document, however, supersedes applicable laws and regulations unless a specific exemption has been obtained

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 MS sheets. The individual item requirements shall be as specified herein and in accordance with the applicable specification sheets In the event of any conflict between requirements of this specification and the specification sheet, the latter shall govern.

3.2 Qualification. The turnbuckle component parts furnished under this specification shall be products which are authorized by the qualifying activity for listing on the applicable qualified products list at the time of award of contract (see 4.3 and 6 4).

3.3 Material. The material used in the manufacture of turnbuckle parts and locking clips shall be as specified herein.

3 3 1 Turnbuckle bodies The turnbuckle bodies shall be made of one of the following materials. All turnbuckle bodies shall be dated showing the year of manufacture by any permanent means available in MIL-STD-130 (see 3 8).

3 3.1 1 Brass bodies. Brass turnbuckle bodies shall be made from UNS C48200 or UNS C46400, hard tempered (H04) per ASTM B21 or seamless brass tubing per MIL-T-6945 The 15 percent minimum elongation value in Table II of MIL-T-

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6945 is changed to 9 percent minimum. Marking by impression stamping, if used, shall be done before stress relieving. Brass turnbuckle bodies shall be stress relieved at 450 degrees F for two hours after fabrication.

3.3 1.2 Steel bodies. Steel turnbuckle bodies shall be made from steel bar per MIL-S-6050 or MIL-S-6758 or seamless steel tubing per MIL-T-6736 or AMS 6530, except that the tensile strength shall be 75,000 PSI minimum.

3.3.1.3 Aluminum bodies. Aluminum turnbuckle bodies shall be made from aluminum alloy temper T4 or T851 per QQ-A-225/6 or tubing material per WW-T-700/3, except that heat treatment shall be T81 or T851 per MIL-H-6088.

3 3 2 Clevis and eye turnbuckle ends. Clevis and eye turnbuckle ends shall be forged or machined from 17-4PH per QQ-S-763 in H1150 condition or cold-rolled or cold-drawn carbon or alloy steel, of which the sulfur content does not exceed 0.050 percent, and the phosphorus content does not exceed 0.040 percent, provided the finished parts conform to applicable requirements of this specification. The carbon or alloy steel is inactive for new designs and the 17-4PH material should be used in current applications wherever possible. Ends not fabricated from heat treated material shall be heat treated per MIL-H-6875 to conform to this specification and the applicable MS sheet.

3.3.3 Locking clip. The locking clip shall be made of corrosion-resisting steel composition 302, condition B, cold finished per ASTM A580.

3.4 Construction. The construction of turnbuckle components shall be as specified herein and on MS21251, 21252, 21253, 21254, 21255 and 21256.

3.4.1 Turnbuckle body and ends. Turnbuckle body and ends shall contain facilities for employing a locking clip which will provide positive safetying of mating parts in assembly.

3.4.1.1 Positive safetying. Positive safetying, for purpose of this specification, is defined as preventing rotational movement between turnbuckle body and end within the requirements of this specification without structural failure of the components or locking clip.

3.4.2 Locking clip. The locking clip shall be constructed as specified herein and on MS21256. It shall be capable of being installed manually without the use of tools and shall be self-retaining in assembly.

3.5 Protective treatment. Turnbuckle parts shall be treated for corrosion protection as specified.

3.5.1 Steel parts. Carbon and alloy steel turnbuckle parts shall be cadmium plated per type II, class 2 of QQ-P-416. Parts made of 17-4PH shall be (a) passivated after the removal of all oil or grease by submerging into a solution containing four parts water to one part commercial nitric acid, specific gravity 1.389 to 1 408, at 125 to 135 degrees F, for 20 to 40 minutes (equivalent method of QQ-P-35 may be used) or (b) glass bead blasted per MIL-STD-852 using beads conforming to MIL-G-9954. Unless otherwise specified, either method for 17-4PH is acceptable. The bore of steel turnbuckle bodies shall be coated with corrosion preventive compound conforming to grade 1 of MIL-C-16173.

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3 5.2 Aluminum parts. Aluminum alloy shall be anodized per MIL-A-8625, type II, Class 1.

3.6 Dimensions. The dimensions of turnbuckle bodies, turnbuckle ends, and the locking clip shall conform to those specified on the applicable MS sheet.

3.6.1 Threads. The internal threads in the turnbuckle bodies shall conform to MIL-S-7742 UNF-3B (see 4.5..1.1). Concentricity between tap hole and threads shall be such that the locking clips can be installed with the terminals engaged to the cross hole for all locking slots (see 4.6.5.1).

3.7 Physical properties.

3.7.1 Rotational movement. The total angular clockwise and counterclockwise rotational movement between turnbuckle body and turnbuckle end with locking clip installed shall not exceed that specified in Table I when subjected to 10 percent of the specified torsion load (see 4.6.1).

TABLE I. Torsion test loads and rotational movement.

MS Standard Dash Number	Minimum Torque (in-lbs)	10% of Torsion Load (in-lbs)	Rotation Movement (maximum degrees)
2	8	0.8	15
3	26	2.6	11
4	82	8.2	8
5	82	8.2	8
6	163	16.3	7
7	318	31.8	6
8	318	31.8	6
9	523	52.3	5
10	750	75.0	4

3.7.2 Torsion. Turnbuckle bodies and ends shall be capable of withstanding the torsional loads specified in Table I, applied clockwise and counterclockwise direction without permanent deformation when tested per 4.6.2.

3.7.3 Tensile fatigue. Turnbuckle bodies and ends shall be capable of withstanding a load equal to 60 percent of the minimum breaking strength (MBS) specified on the applicable MS sheet, applied repeatedly in tension at a rate of approximately one cycle per second for 300 applications without failure, deformation, or permanent increase in overall length of any component part in excess of 0.001 inch per inch in the direction of the application of load (see 4 6 3).

3.7 4 Breaking strength. The MBS strength of turnbuckle parts shall not be less than the values specified on the applicable MS sheet (see 4.6.4).

3.7.5 Bending. Turnbuckle ends shall withstand bending through an angle of 90 degrees without cracking or fracture. Locking clip formed radii shall

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withstand straightening so that the test sample becomes approximately a straight length of wire (see 4.6 6)

3.7.6 Locking clip retention. Locking clips when installed in the turnbuckle assembly shall withstand a removal or disengagement force of 15 lbs when tested per 4.6.5.

3.8 Marking. Turnbuckle bodies and ends shall be marked with manufacturer's name or trademark, and the applicable MS part number per MIL-STD-130. The bodies shall also be marked showing year of manufacture (see 3.3.1). Location of the marking shall be as indicated on the applicable MS sheet Where space will not permit all marking to be located in a single area, the information shall be divided appropriately, and conspicuously located in two adjacent areas. The clip shall be coated with light blue Dykem code DMF (staining color shall be obtained from Dykem Company, 8501 Delport Dr, ST. Louis, MO 63114), or equal. Incomplete coverage shall not be cause for rejection. (Equivalent processes shall be evaluated, when requested, through the QPL engineering office.

3.9 Workmanship. Turnbuckle parts shall be 125 RMS or better and free from burrs, sharp edges, cracks, flaws, pronounced tool marks, or other discontinuities which would prevent proper functioning or performance. Slight burrs in the thread locking area that do not prevent gauging or interfere with installation of the terminal and locking clip are acceptable.

3.10 Penetrant inspection. Brass and aluminum turnbuckle bodies shall be fluorescent penetrant inspected per MIL-STD-6866, type I Any crack visible with the naked eye shall be cause for rejection.

3.11 Reclaimed materials Use of reclaimed material is to be promoted to the greatest extent possible.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements (examinations and tests) as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in this specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to ensure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Responsibility for compliance. All items shall meet all requirements of sections 3 and 5. The inspection set forth in this specification shall become a part of the contractor's overall inspection system or quality program The absence of any inspection requirements in the specification shall not relieve the contractor of the responsibility of ensuring that all products or supplies submitted to the Government for acceptance comply with all requirements of the contract. Sampling inspection, as part of manufacturing operations, is an acceptable practice to ascertain conformance to requirements, however, this does not authorize submission of known defective material, either indicated or actual, nor does it commit the Government to accept defective material

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4.1.1 1 Test facilities. Due to the critical nature of these products and the urgent and ongoing requirement for quality control, it is required that test facilities be located within the continental United States or Canada for ready accessibility to procurement personnel.

4.2 Classification of inspection. The inspection requirements specified herein are classified as follows:

a. Qualification inspection (see 4.3).

b Quality conformance inspection (see 4 4)

4.3 Qualification inspection.

4.3.1 Sampling instructions. Qualification test samples shall consist of four turnbuckle assemblies containing the component part of the type and size upon which qualification is desired. The four turnbuckle assemblies are to be distributed as specified in Table II.

TABLE II. Qualification Test Sample Distribution

Test	Quality
Rotational Movement	1
Torsion	Use rotational movement sample
Tensile Fatigue	1
Breaking Strength	1
Locking Clip Retention	1
Bending	Use breaking strength sample

4.3.2 Tests. The qualification tests of turnbuckle component parts shall consist of all the tests specified under 4.5 and 4.6.

4.4 Quality conformance inspection. Quality conformance tests shall consist of examinations and tests specified under 4.5, 4.6.4, 4.6 5, 4 6.6 and 4.6 7

4.4.1 Inspection lot. An inspection lot shall consist of turnbuckle component parts of the same type, size and material produced under essentially the same manufacturing conditions. The unit of inspection shall be one turnbuckle component part.

4.4.2 Sampling MIL-STD-105 shall be used as a guide in the development of contractors' statistical techniques (i.e. Inspection Level II for examination and S-1 for tests) to assure the components meet all requirements specified herein.

4.4 3 Resubmitted inspection lots Resubmitted lots shall be inspected using tightened inspection (see 4.4 2). Where the original acceptance number

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was zero, a sample size represented by the next higher sample size shall be chosen. Before an inspection lot is resubmitted, full particulars concerning the cause of previous rejection and action taken to correct the defects found, shall be furnished by the contractor to the procuring activity.

4.5 Examinations.

4.5.1 Examination of product. Each sample part shall be examined for conformance to the material, design, dimensional, protective treatment, marking, workmanship and penetrant inspection requirements of this specification and the applicable MS sheet.

4 5 1 1 Threads. Sample turnbuckle bodies, two from the beginning and two from the end of each production run, shall be sectioned longitudinally (one through the clip groove and one at 90 degrees to the groove) and the threads examined per 3.6.1.

4.5.2 Inspection of packaging. Preparation for delivery shall be inspected for conformance to Section 5

4.6 Tests.

4.6.1 Rotational movement. A turnbuckle assembly containing the sample component part with a locking clip installed, shall be subjected to 10 percent of the applicable torque load specified in Table I, applied in a clockwise and counterclockwise direction. The total relative angular rotation between the turnbuckle end and turnbuckle body (less the free play) from the extreme of one direction (clockwise) to the extreme of the other (counterclockwise) shall be measured for conformance to 3.7.1.

4.6.2 Torsion. A turnbuckle assemble containing the sample component part with a locking clip installed shall be subjected to the applicable torque load specified in Table I, applied in a clockwise and counterclockwise direction for five complete cycles The turnbuckle shall then be disassembled and the sample shall be inspected for evidence of failure per 3.7.2. There shall be no evidence of cracks in the sample turnbuckle part of locking clip. Deformation of the turnbuckle or locking clip is acceptable if parts can be disassembled by hand.

4.6.3 Tensile fatigue. A turnbuckle assembly containing the sample component part shall be subjected to a tension load equal to 60 percent of the MBS specified on the applicable MS sheet for the sample, applied repeatedly in tension at a rate of approximately one cycle per second for 300 applications. The turnbuckle assembly shall be disassembled and the sample parts shall be inspected for conformance to 3.7.3. Elongation of the sample turnbuckle part(s) shall be determined per ASTM E8.

4.6.4 Breaking strength. A turnbuckle assembly containing the sample component part shall be tested for MBS by an appropriate means per ASTM E8. The MBS value is that specified on the applicable MS sheet. There shall be no evidence of failure in the sample part. It may be necessary to fabricate special high strength fixtures for attaching to the parts to be tested in order to develop the required loads.

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4.6.5 Locking clip retention. A locking clip shall be installed in a turnbuckle per the instructions specified on MS33736. A direct pull of 15 lbs shall be applied to the locking clip as shown on Figure 1. The locking clip shall not break nor shall the retention feature become disengaged.

4.6.5.1 Functional acceptability. The turnbuckle body and mating terminals must be assembled and the locking clip inserted in each end of the turnbuckle body. After removing clips the terminals are rotated one half turn and the locking clip inserted once again. This functional assembly requirement tests every combination of the locking capability of the assembly.

4.6.6 Bending. Turnbuckle parts shall be tested for bending as follows.

4.6.6.1 Turnbuckle ends. Sample turnbuckle ends that pass the breaking strength test (4.6.4) shall be held in a square-nosed vise and the shank bent through an angle of 90 degrees. There shall be no evidence of failure or cracking when inspected with the naked eye. Small fissures that require microscopic examination for detection are not considered failures.

4.6.6.2 Locking clip. Locking clip must withstand straightening with the use of pliers. The various formed radii shall be straightened so that the sample becomes approximately a straight length of wire. This is to insure that brittleness has not been induced in the formed areas of the clip. There shall be no evidence of failure or cracking when inspected with the naked eye. Small fissures that require microscopic examination for detection are not considered failures.

4.6.7 Hardness. Finished brass turnbuckle bodies shall have a minimum hardness of R15T-70.

4.7 Retention of qualification. Every two years contractor's shall submit certification to the qualification activity stating they still manufacture the item in the same manner as qualified and do not have uncorrected process deficiencies. This shall be coordinated with the local government inspector and signed accordingly.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Preservation. Preservation shall be level A or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A.

5.1.1.1 Cleaning and drying. Turnbuckles shall be cleaned per MIL-P-116 process C-1 and dried per MIL-P-116.

5.1.1.2 Preservative applications. Preservatives are not required.

5.1.1.3 Unit packs. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), each turnbuckle shall be individually unit packed per MIL-P-116, method IC-3.

5.1.1.4 Intermediate packs. Intermediate packs shall be used per MIL-STD-2073-1.

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5.1.2 Level C. The level C preservation for turnbuckles shall conform to MIL-P-116, method III.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.3).

5.2.1 Level A. The preserved turnbuckles shall be packed in an exterior container selected from those listed in MIL-STD-2073-1, Table I as having level A applicability.

5.2.2 Level B The preserved turnbuckles shall be packed in an exterior container selected from those listed in MIL-STD-2073-1, Table I as having level B applicability.

5.2.3 Level C. The level C packing for turnbuckles shall conform to MIL-STD-2073-1 requirements for this level.

5 2.4 Consolidated and unitized loads. Consolidated or unitized loads shall be used per MIL-STD-2073-1.

5.3 Marking. In addition to any special or other identification marking required by the contract (see 6.2), each unit pack, intermediate and exterior container and unitized load shall be marked per MIL-STD-129.

6 NOTES

(This section contains information of a general or explanatory nature that may be helpful, but is not mandatory.)

6.1 Intended use. Turnbuckles and component parts are intended for use in the construction of aircraft and aircraft accessories.

6.2 Acquisition requirements. Acquisition documents should specify the following:

a. Title, number, and date of this specification.

b. Name of part

c. Part number.

d. Issue of DODISS to be cited in the solicitation, and if required, the specific issue of individual documents referenced (see 2.1.1 and 2 2).

e. Applicable levels of packaging and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).

6.3 Qualification. With respect to products requiring qualification, awards will be made only for products which are, at the time of award of contract, qualified for inclusion in Qualified Products List, QPL-8788 whether or not such products have actually been so listed by that date. The attention of the contractors is called to these requirements, and manufacturers are urged to arrange to have the products that they propose to offer to the Federal Government tested for qualification in order that they may be eligible to be awarded contracts or purchase orders for the products covered by this specification The activity responsible for the Qualified Products List is SA-

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ALC/LDIE, Kelly AFB, TX 78241 and information pertaining to qualification of products may be obtained from that activity.

6 4 Subject term (key word) listing.

Connectors
Fittings
Wire rope assemblies

6.5 Changes from the previous issue. Marginal notes are not used in this revision to identify changes with respect to the previous issue due to the extensiveness of the changes

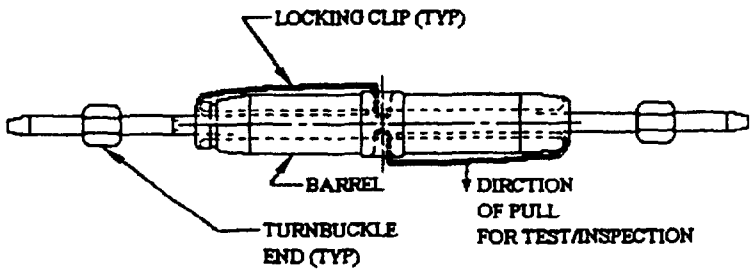


FIGURE 1. Locking Clip Retention

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Custodians.
Air Force - 99
Navy - AS
Army - ME
DLA - IS

User activity:
Army - ME

Preparing activity:
Air Force - 82

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

INSTRUCTIONS

1 The preparing activity must complete blocks 1, 2, 3, and 8 In block 1, both the document number and revision letter should be given

2 The submitter of this form must complete blocks 4, 5, 6, and 7

3 The preparing activity must provide a reply within 30 days from receipt of the form

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I RECOMMEND A CHANGE:	1 DOCUMENT NUMBER MIL-T-8878	2 DOCUMENT DATE (YYMMDD) 18 April 1994

3 DOCUMENT TITLE
TURNBUCKLES, POSITIVE SAFETYING

4. NATURE OF CHANGE (Identify paragraph number and include proposed rewrite, if possible Attach extra sheets as needed)

5. REASON FOR RECOMMENDATION

6. SUBMITTER

a. NAME (Last, First, Middle Initial)	b. ORGANIZATION	
c. ADDRESS (Include Zip Code)	d TELEPHONE (Include Area Code) (1) Commercial (2) AUTOVON (If applicable)	7. DATE SUBMITTED (YYMMDD)

8 PREPARING ACTIVITY

a NAME SA-ALC/TILDD	b TELEPHONE (Include Area Code) (1) Commercial (210) 925-6314	(2) AUTOVON 945-6314
c ADDRESS (Include Zip Code) 485 Quentin Roosevelt Rd. Kelly AFB, TX 78241-6524	IF YOU DO NOT RECEIVE A REPLY WITHIN 45 DAYS, CONTACT Defense Quality and Standardization Office 5203 Leesburg Pike, Suite 1403, Falls Church, VA 22041-3466 Telephone (703) 756-2340 AUTOVON 289-2340	

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